

Word family: **suspect** / **suspects** / **suspected** / **suspecting** / **suspicion** / **suspicious** / **suspiciously**

Base word: **suspect**

Forms: **suspects**, **suspected**, **suspecting**

Related forms: **suspicion**, **suspicious**, **suspiciously**

Part of speech: **verb** (動詞) / **noun** (名詞) / **adjective** (形容詞 , 較正式 / 較少見)

Your sentence:

> “It may not be the kind of book I can race through in a weekend, but I **suspect** it will give me more to reflect on.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **suspect** means **to think that something is probably true, although you are not certain and may not have enough evidence to know for sure**.

繁體中文： **懷疑 / 估計某件事大概是真的，但並不完全確定**

中文翻譯：

> “I **suspect** it will give me more to reflect on.”

「我**估計 / 猜想**它會帶給我更多值得反思的內容。」

Here:

suspect = 根據感覺、跡象或推測，認為某件事很可能是真的

1. **suspect** = think something is probably true (推測) — 懷疑；估計；猜想

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To believe that something is probably true, while still being uncertain.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I **suspect** the book will give me a lot to think about.”

「我**估計 / 猜想**這本書會令我思考很多。」

Practice 2

> “I **suspect** he already knows the answer.”

「我**懷疑** / 估計**他**已經知道答案。」

Practice 3

> “She **suspected** that something was wrong.”

「她**懷疑****有些**事情不對勁。」

suspect + clause = 認為某件事大概是真的，但沒有完全確定

Common:

- * suspect that...
- * strongly suspect
- * begin to suspect
- * have reason to suspect

2. **suspect = think someone may have done something wrong (懷疑某人) — 懷疑；認為有嫌疑**

Suspect can mean believing that a person may be responsible for a crime, dishonest act, or wrongdoing.

Practice 4

> “The police **suspected** him of theft.”

「警方**懷疑**他涉及盜竊。」

Practice 5

> “She **suspected** her colleague of lying.”

「她**懷疑**同事說謊。」

suspect someone of something = 懷疑某人做了不當、違法或不誠實的事情

This is a major distinct verb pattern.

3. **suspect = doubt the honesty, safety, or reliability of something (可疑) — 對.....有疑心；覺**

得不可靠**

Suspect can also mean thinking that something may be false, unsafe, unreliable, or problematic.

Practice 6

> “Doctors **suspected** an infection.”

「醫生**懷疑**有感染。」

Practice 7

> “They **suspected** a problem with the engine.”

「他們**懷疑**引擎出了問題。」

suspect something = 認為某個問題、原因、疾病或風險可能存在

For strict counting, this still belongs closely to Meaning 1:

> think something is probably the case.

So I would not split it further.

4. **suspect = a person believed to be involved in a crime (名詞) — 嫌疑人**

As a noun, **suspect** means a person believed to possibly have committed a crime.

Practice 8

> “The police arrested a **suspect**.”

「警方拘捕了一名**嫌疑人**。」

Practice 9

> “The main **suspect** was questioned for several hours.”

「主要**嫌疑人**被問話數小時。」

suspect = 被認為可能涉及犯罪或不法行為的人

This is a major noun sense.

5. **suspect** = questionable / doubtful (形容詞) — 可疑的 ; 不可靠的

As an adjective, **suspect** can mean doubtful, unreliable, or suspicious.

Practice 10

> “The evidence is **suspect**.”

「這項證據很**可疑 / 不可靠**。」

Practice 11

> “His explanation seemed **suspect**.”

「他的解釋看起來有點**可疑**。」

suspect = 令人懷疑其真實性、可靠性或正當性的

This use is more formal and less common than **suspicious**.

Related form: **suspicion**

Suspicion means a feeling or belief that something may be wrong, dishonest, dangerous, or true.

Practice 12

> “She had a **suspicion** that he was hiding something.”

「她**懷疑**他有所隱瞞。」

Practice 13

> “The police became increasingly **suspicious** of his story.”

「警方對他的說法越來越**懷疑**。」

Useful distinction:

* **suspicion** = noun

* **suspicious** = adjective

Related form: **suspicious**

Suspicious has two important patterns.

suspicious of someone/something — 對……懷疑

Practice 14

> “She was **suspicious of** his explanation.”

「她對他的解釋感到**懷疑**。」

something looks suspicious — 某物看起來可疑

Practice 15

> “The package looked **suspicious**.”

「那個包裹看起來很**可疑**。」

So **suspicious** can describe either:

* the person who feels doubt

* the thing that causes doubt

Related form: **suspiciously**

Practice 16

> “He looked at me **suspiciously**.”

「他**懷疑地**看着我。」

Practice 17

> “The price was **suspiciously** low.”

「那個價格低得**有點可疑**。」

suspiciously = 以懷疑的方式；或低 / 高 / 安靜等程度異常得令人起疑

Important distinction: **suspect vs think**

think

is neutral.

> “I think he is right.”

= 我認為他是對的。

suspect

adds uncertainty and often suggests indirect evidence or intuition.

> “I suspect he is right.”

= 我估計 / 懷疑他大概是對的，但不完全確定。

So **suspect** is less certain and more inferential.

Important distinction: **suspect vs doubt**

These are often confused.

suspect

usually means:

> think something is probably true.

doubt

usually means:

> think something may not be true.

Compare:

> “I suspect he lied.”

= 我懷疑他說了謊。

→ I think he probably lied.

> “I doubt he lied.”

= 我懷疑他有沒有說謊 / 我不太相信他說了謊。

→ I think he probably did not lie.

This is one of the most important distinctions.

Important distinction: **suspect vs guess**

guess

can be based on little or no evidence.

suspect

usually suggests there is some reason, sign, intuition, or indirect evidence.

> “I guess it will rain.”

more casual.

> “I suspect it will rain.”

sounds more like there are reasons to think so.

Important distinction: **suspect vs assume**

assume

means accept something as true for the moment, often without proof.

suspect

means think something is probably true, but remain uncertain.

> assume the train is on time

> suspect the train is delayed

Different mental stance.

Important distinction: **suspect vs suspicious**

suspect as verb

> “I suspect him.”

= 我懷疑他。

suspicious describing the observer

> “I am suspicious of him.”

= 我對他有疑心。

suspicious describing the thing/person causing doubt

> “His behaviour is suspicious.”

= 他的行為很可疑。

Important distinction: **suspect vs accuse**

suspect

means believe someone may have done something wrong.

accuse

means state or claim that someone did it.

> suspect someone of theft

> accuse someone of theft

An accusation is stronger and more explicit.

Grammar note: **suspect that / suspect someone of**

Two important patterns:

suspect that + clause

> “I suspect that he knows.”

= 我估計他知道。

suspect someone of + noun/-ing

> “They suspected him of cheating.”

= 他們懷疑他作弊。

Not:

> “suspect him to cheat” ❌

Countability note

As a noun, **suspect** is countable:

> a suspect

> several suspects

Suspicion can be:

countable

> “I had a suspicion that...”

uncountable/abstract

> “His behaviour aroused suspicion.”

Both patterns are common.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **suspect**

* **suspects**

* **suspected**

* **suspecting**

* **suspicion**

* **suspicious**
* **suspiciously**

Useful constructions include:

* suspect that...
* suspect someone of something
* strongly suspect
* a suspect
* suspicious of
* arouse suspicion

The key curation distinction is between **epistemic suspicion**—thinking something is probably true—and **criminal/person-focused suspicion**—believing someone may be responsible for wrongdoing. These share a broad uncertainty concept but are useful enough to separate in learner-facing mapping.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
suspect — think probably true	根據跡象或推測，認為某件事大概是真的，但並不完全確定
suspect someone of something	懷疑某人做了不當、違法或不誠實的事情
suspect — noun	被認為可能涉及犯罪或不法行為的人；嫌疑人
suspect — adjective	真實性、可靠性或正當性令人懷疑的；可疑的
suspicion	懷疑、疑心；認為可能有問題的感覺
suspicious	對某人 / 某事有懷疑；或本身令人起疑的
suspiciously	懷疑地；或異常得令人起疑地

For your original sentence

> “I **suspect** it will give me more to reflect on.”

The exact meaning is:

suspect = 我並不完全確定，但根據目前的印象，我認為這很可能會發生

So:

> **I suspect it will give me more to reflect on.**

= **我估計 / 我猜想這本書大概會帶給我更多值得反思的內容。**

Here, **suspect** does **not** have any criminal meaning.

For your database, I would count **4** genuinely useful core meanings for **suspect**:

1. **verb** — think something is probably true
2. **verb** — believe someone may have done something wrong
3. **noun** — a person believed to be involved in wrongdoing
4. **adjective** — questionable or doubtful

I would keep **suspicion / suspicious / suspiciously** as family extensions, and merge ordinary “suspect a problem/disease/cause” uses into #1 rather than inflate the count.